dissatisfied customer leaves the site. However, we get new stock after a day or two, and the book is added to the inventory. Now, because the book reappears in our inventory, we want to notify the user so they can purchase it.

Elasticsearch supports this use case by providing a special `percolate` query, which uses the `percolator` field type. The `percolate` query is the opposite of our normal search query mechanism in that instead of running the query against documents, we search for a query given a document. This is a strange concept at first glance, but we demystify it in this section. Figure 12.14 shows the differences between a normal query and a `percolate` query.

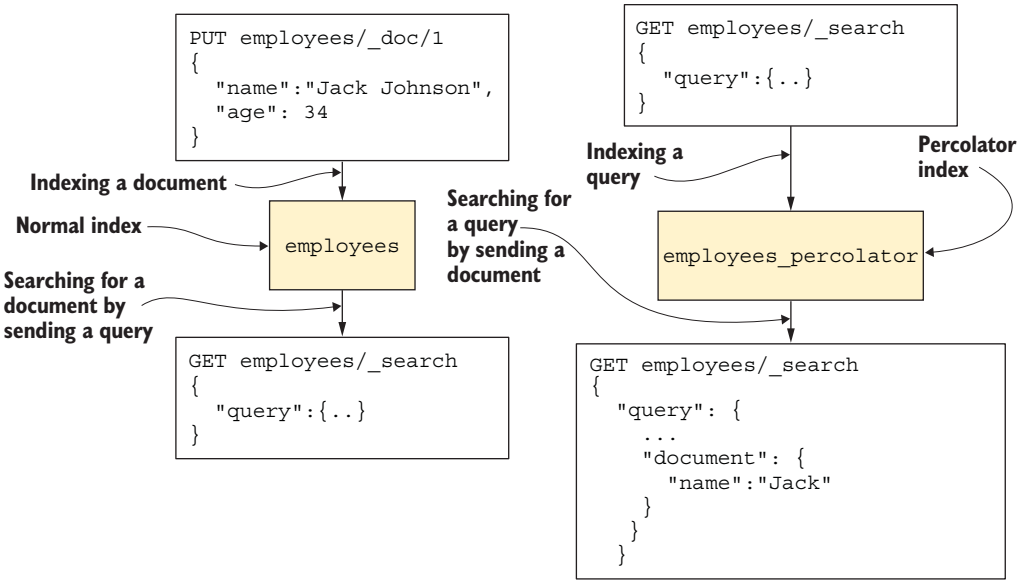


Figure 12.14 Normal vs. `percolate` queries

Let's see `percolate` queries in action by first indexing some documents. The following listing indexes three technical books into the `tech_books` index. Note that we do not include a Python book yet.

Listing 12.27 Indexing technical books

```
PUT tech_books/_doc/1
{
  "name":"Effective Java",
  "tags":["Java","Software engineering", "Programming"]
}

PUT tech_books/_doc/2
{
```